

than not, choose to log into a virtual console. This is largely due to default configuration of the system messages that causes them to be displayed on the system console. Consequently, these messages keep appearing over the file or the command that the user is working and operating on, making it highly challenging for them to concentrate on their allotted work in the process. In the FreeBSD operating system, every virtual console comes with a login prompt and shell, making it very simple to switch between virtual consoles. Essentially, this arrangement presents the command-line equivalent of keeping multiple windows open simultaneously in a graphical user interface environment.

Switching between virtual consoles

One can use the entire range of keyword combinations from `[Alt] + [F1]` through `[Alt] + [F8]` to switch between various consoles within the FreeBSD environment. Once you use `[Alt] + [F1]` to switch to the system console, you can subsequently use `[Alt] + [F2]` to navigate to the first virtual console, `[Alt] + [F3]` for the second one, `[Alt] + [F4]` for the third one, and so on. When using Xorg like a graphical console, you have to press the combination `[Ctrl] + [Alt] + [F1]` to revert to the text-oriented virtual console. FreeBSD takes care of the screen output while you're switching from one console to the next. As a result, it creates an illusion of there being multiple keyboards and virtual screens at your disposal to type executable commands in the FreeBSD environment. It is important to remember that running the programs executed in one virtual console does not stop while you switch to a separate virtual console. If you want to disable any particular virtual console, you just have to put `#` (comment symbol) at the start of the line, representing the virtual console in question.

The single user mode

Additionally, the FreeBSD boot menu offers users a 'Boot Single User' option, which, if selected, allows users to boot the system into a special mode called the 'single-user mode.' This mode's primary objective is to repair a system that refuses to boot. Alternatively, it is also used to reset the root password if it is unknown. Bear in mind that, while using the single-user mode, you will be able to access neither networking nor any other virtual consoles in the system. Only the full root access to the system is at the user's disposal. Additionally, the need for the root password is also eliminated. To boot in this mode, however, one must have physical access to the keyboard.